PROSE

15/02/26

Syllabus - D - Detailed, ND - Not - Detailed

Imp - Lessons in Red are studied in each unit.

1. Unit - I

Francis Bacon - Of Studies, Of Truth, Of Friendship, Of Great Place All D

Thomas Browne - Urn Burial ND

John Milton - Areopatigica ND

2. Unit - II

Addison and Steele : Coverly Papers - Essay No.
1 - The Spectator's Account Of Himself
110 - On Ghost and Appaoritions
112 - Sir Roger at Church
117 - On Witch Craft - Story Of Moll White
119 - Rural Manners All D

James Boswell - Life Of Dr. Johnson ND

Benjamin Franklin - Autobiography ND

3. Unit - III

Charles Lamb - Dream Children: A Reverie, A Bachelor's Complaint, Christ Hospital All D

W. Hazlitt - On Going a journey - Indian Jugglers, Confessions of an opium eater ND

4 Unit - IV

Thomas Carlyle - Hero as a poet ND

J. Ruskin - Sesame and Lilies ND

A.G. Gardiner - On Saying please, On the Rule of the Road - All D

5 Unit - V

Montaigne - (Florio's Translation) Of Idleness, Of Reade or Slow Speech, That we should not judge our happiness Until after our death All D

Thomas More - Utopia ND

Machiavelli - The prince ND

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Francis Bacon - Of Studies, Of Truth, Of Friendship, Of Great place All D

About the Writer -

Francis Bacon (1561 - 1626)

Era and Age - Elizabethan Era/Age, Jacobean Age of Shakespeare, date 16th - Early 17th Century Early prose writer of English Renaissance elizabethan (1558-1603) and Jacobean (1603-1625)

Titles -

1. "Father of English Essay" - literary critics
2. "Father of Empericism" - Philosophers

Admirers - Influenced enlightment thinkers, Admired for practical wisdom

Critics -

- Accused of corruption in political career
- Some critics call his essays too concise and aphoristic

Contribution -

- Introduced aphoritistic essay style.
- Developed Scientific method (inductive

reasoning).

- Made english prose clear, direct and logical.

Essays -

1. On Studies -

Explains the value and purpose of study. He says it serve 3 main purposes - delight, ornament and ability.

Themes -

1. Importance of balanced study
2. Practical wisdom
3. Knowledge and self - development

Important Quotes -

1. "Reading maketh a full man; Conference a ready man; and writing an exact man."

Reading gives knowledge.

2. On Truth -

Discusses why people love lies more than truth. He says truth is like daylight -

Clear but sometimes harsh. Lies provide imagination and pleasure.

Themes -

1. Truth Vs falsehood
2. Moral philosophy
3. Human weakness

Important Quotes -

1. "What is truth? said jesting Pilate; and would not stay for an answer."

People often question truth but do not seek it.

2. "Truth is a naked and open daylight..."

Clear but Harsh.

3. On Friendship -

Friendship is necessary for emotional relief. Calls it greatest blessings in life.

Themes -

1. Emotional comfort
2. Honest counsel, value of companionship

Important Quotes -

1 "A principal fruit of friendship is the ease and discharge of the fulness of the heart."

Friendship relieves emotional burden.

4 Of Great Place -

Responsibilities of people in high positions. A person in power must serve the public.

Themes -

Responsibility of leadership, Power and morality, public service.

Important Quotes -

1. "Men in great place are thrice servants."

They serve the State, reputation and business.

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Addison and Steele - Coverley Papers -
Essay No. 1, 110, 112, 117, 119 All D

About the Writers -

Joseph Addison (1672 - 1719)

Era and Age - Neo-Classical Age / Age of Reason / Augustan Age, Early 18th Century (1700-1750) Age of Pope

Titles -

1. "Master of English prose style" - Critics

Admirers - praised by Samuel Johnson, Respected for moral essays

Critics - Sometimes called Overly moralizing

Contribution - Polished periodical essay, Improved middle class taste and Manners, Brought balance and Clarity to prose.

Richard Steele (1672 - 1729)

Era and Age - Neo-Classical Age / Age of Reason / Augustan Age, Early 18th century / Age of Pope (1700-1750)

Titles -

1. "Pioneer Of Periodical Journalism" -
Critics

Admirers -

Worked closely with Addison, appreciated for emotional and humane style.

Critics - Considered less polished than Addison

Contribution -

- Founded modern periodical essay
- Focused on social reform and morality
- Made literature accessible to common readers.

Combined contribution Of Addison and Steele -

- Founded english periodical essay tradition.
- Promoted moral and ethical values.
- Shaped 18th century journalism.

Coverley Papers -

Presents the character Of Sir Roger de

Coverley, a country gentleman. Through humorous and gentle satire, the essays portray 18th-century English, domestic life, manners and moral behavior.

Sir Roger is kind but slightly eccentric. His interactions with servants, church members, and townpeople show social values and human weakness.

Themes - Social manners, Morality and virtue, Gentle satire, Domestic life, Humor with moral lesson

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Characters -

Sir Roger de Coverley
- → Kind, traditional, humorous, Country squire
- → Generous
- → Traditional Country gentleman
- → Symbol Of old English values
- → Character sketch essay

Essays -

1. Essay No. 1 - "The Spectator's account Of Himself"

Introduction - Introduces the narrator "Mr.

Spectator" and the Spectator Club.

Spectator describes-

- His Silent Nature
- Habit of observing people
- Education and travels

110. Essay No. 110 - "On Ghosts and Apparitions"

Introduction - Belief in ghosts and Superstitions.

He argues - (Spectator:- Addison

- Fear and imagination create ghosts
- weak minds believe easily

Important lines / Quotes -

"Fear gives birth to imaginary beings."

112. Essay No. 112 - "Sir Roger at Church"

Introduction - Description of Sir Roger's behavior at Church.

We See Sir Roger Controls -

1. He Controls Seating arrangement
2. He Corrects villagers.
3. Gives prayer books to poor people
4. Shows Authority and kindness

Important line -

He "would often stand up when he was not called to it".

117. Essay No. 117 - "On Witchcraft - Story of Moll White"

Introduction - Superstition and Witchcraft.

Villagers accuse an old women, Moll White of being a witch.

119. Essay No. 119 - "Rural Manners"

Introduction - Depiction of Country lives and Customs

Spectator describes Village behavior

Important lines -

1. "The manners of Villagers are plain but honest."

2. "Their innocence is their greatest charm"

Sir Roger development in Essays-

Essay 1 → Introduced as Club 'The Spectator Member'
⇓
Essay 112 → Shown as religious leader (Church Scene)
⇓
Essay 117 → Reveals Superstition (Moll white episode
⇓
Essay 119 → Shows rural manners to leadership
⇓
Gradually becomes "Central emotional figure"

Strengths	Weaknesses
1. Compassionate	1. Superstitious
2. Loyal	2. Slightly Controlling
3. Responsible landlord	3. Conservative mindset
4. Morally upright	4. Emotionally wounded (unmarried due to failed love).
5. Hospitable	

Unit - 3

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Charles Lamb - Dream Children: A reverie, A Bachelor's Complaint, Christ Hospital All D

About the Writer -

Charles Lamb (1775 - 1834)

Era and Age - Romantic Age, Late 18th - Early 19th Century (1798 - 1832)

Titles - "prince of English Essayists" - Critics

Admirers - Wordsworth and Coleridge

Critics - Considered too personal and nostalgic

Contribution -

1. Perfected personal essays
2. Added humour, Pathos and intimacy to prose.
3. Made essay more autobiographical

Essays of Elia -

Collection of essays by Charles Lamb, elia is his pen name meaning "God has answered".

All this 3 essays are from this Collection.

1. Dream Children : A Reverie –

Lamb imagines telling stories to his dream children about his past love, Alice. Suddenly, he realizes they are only imaginary. The essay ends with emotional loneliness.

Themes –

1. Memory and loss
2. Nostalgia and lost family dreams
3. Unfulfilled love

Important Quotes –

1. "We are such stuff as dreams are made on."
2. "Alas! my children, you never were."
3. "We are nothing; less than nothing, and dreams."
4. "Children love to listen to stories about their elders."

2. A Bachelor's Complaint of the Behaviour of Married People –

A humorous yet ironic complaint about how married friends neglect bachelors. Describes difficulties faced by bachelors in social life. He presents bachelorhood with wit and irony.

Themes –

1. Social satire, Humor and bachelorhood
2. Personal reflection

Important Quotes –

1. "The greatest unhappiness is to be married without love."
2. "I am considered as a piece of unmarried property." – from himself (a bachelor).
3. "They have a world of their own." – from married friends

3. Christ Hospital Five and Thirty Years Ago –

Lamb recalls his school days. He contrasts his experience with Coleridge's. Shows realism and childhood memories.

Themes – School life, childhood memories,

discipline, Injustice

Important Quotes -

1. "I remember L. at School..." (to School mate) (L-) S.T Coleridge)
2. "We were supposed to suffer."
3. "I was a poor friendless boy." (Lamb refers to himself)

Unit - 4

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Thomas Carlyle - Hero as a poet ND

About the writer -

Thomas Carlyle (1795 - 1881)

Era and Age - Victorian Age, 19th Century (1832 - 1887)

Titles - "Sage of Chelsea" - Critics

Admirers - Influenced Victorian thinkers

Critics -

1. Criticized for authoritarian ideas
2. Style considered complex and intense

Contribution -

1. Developed historical and philosophical prose
2. Emphasized Heroism and leadership
3. Influenced Victorian moral thought

Hero as a poet -

Themes - Heroism and literary greatness, Hero worship, Power of Poetry, Spiritual leadership

Carlyle argues that poets are true heroes

because they express divine truth. He discusses figures like Dante and Shakespeare.

A poet reveals deeper spiritual realities. Poet is a prophet and guide of humanity.

Important Quotes -

"The hero is the man who inspires and elevates."

Unit - 5

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Thomas More - Utopia ND

About the Writer -

Thomas More (1478 - 1535)

Era and Age -

Renaissance period, 16th Century (1485 - 1660)

Titles -

1. Canonized as a Saint by Catholic Church (1935).
2. Known as a great renaissance humanist.

Admirers - Desiderius Erasmus, Catholic Church

Critics - Protestant historians for opposing reformation

Contribution -

1. Introduced the concept of ideal society in Utopia.
2. Criticized social injustice, corruption and inequality in England.
3. Influenced political philosophy and social thought.

Utopia -

Utopia describes an imaginary Island with perfect social, political and economic systems.

Their is no private property. Education is valued. Religious tolerance exists.

More criticizes corruption and injustice in England by contrasting it with ideal Utopia.

Themes - Ideal Society, Social reform, Justice and equality, Ideal governance

Important Quotes -

1. "An ideal society values justice above wealth."

2. "In Utopia, where everything belongs to everyone, no one has anything."

3. "A man would rather choose to be merry than wise."

4. "No man ought to be punished for his religion."